



Vu meter to check levels on a recorder.

most of the noise and no amount of post production and filters and studio magic is going to bring back the richness that a normal tone of voice has.

The second item on your list is a recorder. Once again, whether you really need this depends on things.

‘Who is going to be watching, how much is your budget and does my camera have a mic input,’ are the questions you need to be asking yourself.

While buying, make sure the recorder records .WAV files. Unless compressed audio is what you really need. The second thing you need to look at is the bit depth and the sampling rate. To make things easier to understand, let’s draw a parallel between a sample rate and the frames per second in your camera. When you shoot at a higher FPS, you capture more info, or in this case detail. If you imagine each of these samples stored in containers, you’ll see that a higher bit depth results in more space for the details and together they give you good quality sound.

While CD quality (44.1 kHz and 16 bit.) is good, if you’re going to be tweaking the sound in post, aim higher and go 96kHz and 24 bit.

The final requirement is a good quality mixer. Once again, the quality of your sound can be greatly influenced by the presence of a mixer between your mic and your recorder. But they’re clunky and sometimes require a power source. The advantage is that you can tie together several inputs and mix them down to one track.

This brings us to the second professional application of sound recording, which is music.

If you’ve seen half the music videos, they’re shot on studio these days. While it may have gone from unique to tacky faster than an Saturn V rocket, recording sound in a studio is essential.

The studio serves as a location where you can record unadulterated samples without having to worry about disturbances interfering with the recordings. But when you move into a small room, you come face to ear with room tone. Sound is nothing but disturbances travelling through the air and